

✓ What is Safe Mode?

- **Safe Mode** is a special way to start Windows with **only the essential drivers and services**.
- It helps **troubleshoot problems** like software conflicts, malware, or driver issues.
- In Safe Mode, many features are disabled, so you can isolate and fix problems without interference.
- You can access Safe Mode by pressing **F8** (or through recovery options in newer Windows versions).

✓ What is Secure Boot?

- **Secure Boot** is a security feature found in **UEFI firmware** (modern BIOS).
- It helps **protect your PC from malware during startup** by allowing only trusted software to load.
- If malware tries to load before Windows, Secure Boot blocks it.
- It improves system security by **checking digital signatures** of boot loaders and drivers.

◆ Quick Comparison:

Feature	Safe Mode	Secure Boot
Purpose	Troubleshooting and fixing problems	Protect system during boot-up
When used	When Windows isn't working right	Every time PC starts (if enabled)
What it does	Loads minimal drivers/services	Blocks untrusted software from loading

Method 1: Using Settings

1. Open Settings

Press **Windows + I**.

2. Go to Recovery

Navigate to:

System → Recovery

3. Under **Advanced startup**, click **Restart now**.

4. Your PC will restart and show the **Choose an option** screen.

5. Select **Troubleshoot** → **Advanced options** → **Startup Settings** → **Restart**.

6. After restart, you'll see a list of options. Press the number for the Safe Mode option you want:

- Press **4** for Safe Mode
- Press **5** for Safe Mode with Networking
- Press **6** for Safe Mode with Command Prompt

Method 2: Using Shift + Restart

1. Click the **Start menu**.

2. Click the **Power** button.

3. Hold **Shift** and click **Restart**.

4. Follow steps 4 to 6 from Method 1 above.

Method 3: Using System Configuration (msconfig)

1. Press **Windows + R**, type msconfig, and hit Enter.
2. Go to the **Boot** tab.
3. Check **Safe boot** and choose the type (Minimal for normal Safe Mode).
4. Click **OK** and restart your PC.